



الجامعة الألمانية الأردنية  
German Jordanian University

School of Applied Technical Sciences

DS-301

Engineering Economics Project

Proposal

**Reflections**

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## Executive Summary

This file presents my **reflection, experience** and **personal challenges** while working on the **Engineering Economics project**, which aimed to apply engineering economics principles to evaluate proposals for LBP training and equipment options. The reflections cover my experience throughout the project period, on both the **pre-separation** and **post-separation (teaming up with Bahaa)** of the project.

The initial team suffered from **poor communication, lack of data sharing**, and **minimal cooperation**, which **stalled** progress. Despite these early setbacks, the final work provided a clear recommendation and demonstrated how **focused team effort** can achieve results under **extremely tight deadlines**.

## Reflection 1: Team Communication

In the first team, we used the **simplest method** for **communication**, which is using **WhatsApp**. But most of the members managed to completely **ignore messages, calls** and even emails to reach out, unfortunately the **individual who was responsible for data collection was one of them**.

To add more, **all the team** members (including me) showed **lack of energy, excitement** and **willingness** to work. After providing the **so-called Data**, I tried to provide **ideas** for **expansions** and **researches**, **all were ignored**.

After separating with Bahaa, there was no time to be wasted, so we did not have any issues with communicating. It was as perfect as it is supposed to be.

## Reflection 2: Task distribution

*Everything in this section describes the first team.*

In the first team the task distribution was affected by the lack of communication, but what made it a reflection is complete ignorance of each one's own capability to complete the task. When someone chooses to take a task, he should be able to **distinguish its quality, recognize when help is needed** and **estimate** time required. I will explain as follows:

- **Data Collection:** Most important task, the individual who took responsibility refused to get help (even when there is someone in the team working in the same company), refused to help with calculations and analysis, and did not provide updates. After more than a week, the proposal was shared, but only after spending time removing the client's name. In the end, it was presented as a simple screenshot labeled "raw data" on the final day.

- Reports: As simple as it is to prepare a report nowadays, most were completed less than 12 hours before the meeting. The individuals responsible for the two reports consistently sent their work the night before submission, and unsurprisingly, the quality was poor. As a result, we had to redo them entirely.

## Reflection 3: Separation

After the separation on Tuesday, Bahaa took the lead on data collection since the sources were from his company, while I focused on conducting research. By Friday evening, all the required data had been provided, more than double what we initially expected.

From that point, between Friday and Sunday before the meeting, we implemented an exceptionally effective system of communication. Every task was clearly assigned, updates were frequent, and decisions were made quickly. We discussed each step in detail, agreed on every aspect of the work, and ensured that our analysis and interpretations were fully aligned. The collaboration was **seamless, no wasted time, no confusion, and complete mutual understanding**. It was, without question, the **smoothest and most productive working period of the entire project**.

## Reflection 4: Time

The **first two weeks** of the project were **relatively calm**, with little to do beyond preparing a **basic reports**. In the **third and fourth weeks**, I faced **health issues**, yet I still **managed to complete my part of the work**.

In the fifth week, the separation happened and what followed felt like a **two-day marathon**. The workload seemed impossible at first, but we each dedicated **20+ hours in 3 days** to get it done. Even with Bahaa's **demanding travel schedule** from Irbid to Wadi Al Rimam to Madaba which left me working alone for many hours, we still managed to complete everything barley on time.

## Reflection 5: Burn-out & Health

**Burnout** is a state of physical and mental exhaustion caused by prolonged or excessive stress. That is how I would **describe myself** after second semester finals.

I was able to achieve **90+ GPA** 17 CH semester, **passing B1 German TestDaF** exam, passing **B2 track exams**, attending **international robotics week in Germany** which took place one week before B1 exams and two weeks before projects submissions, and **achieved highest mark** in every project I worked on.

After all that, I got one day off, then started economics course where most students had cars, they refused to change the time of the lecture, which was extremely annoying and demanding.

As a Dual Studies Student, that was the case for the **past 3 years**, perhaps it is preparation for real life, with less than a month of holidays per year. I am sure there are students with more challenging circumstances, but I believe **burnout** is the **cost of being driven by passion rather than fear**.

I also got a **virus** that left me bedridden for a full week. Shortly after, I had to undergo **eye surgery**, which resulted in another week of pain and limited vision, working effectively with only one eye.

## Reflection 6: Decision-Making Under Pressure

One of the **most valuable lessons** from this project was **learning** how to **make quick** yet **well-informed decisions under severe time constraints**. After the separation, there was no room for **trial-and-error**; **every calculation, method, and analysis** had to **be selected with confidence and executed without delay**. This required prioritizing the most critical tasks, **letting go of less important details**, and trusting our own judgment. The experience showed me that in engineering projects, the **ability to make decisions quickly** can be just **as important as the quality of the technical work itself**.

## Reflection 7: Ability to Make a Real Conversation

One of the unexpected benefits of this project was the added value it gave me in understanding basic economic concepts. Engineering Economics not only enhanced my technical knowledge but also gave me the confidence to engage in meaningful discussions on topics like investment evaluation, cost analysis, and financial decision-making.

This foundation proved especially valuable when speaking with experts at EY, as I was able to follow their explanations, ask informed questions, and contribute to the conversation in a way that felt both professional and credible.

## Reflection 8: Creating a new interest

**Engineering Economics** sparked a **new personal interest** in the world of investing. **The concepts** of returns, risk analysis, and present value **not only applied to the project** but also inspired me to **explore real investment opportunities**. I began researching shares and

bonds, as well as major market indices such as the **NASDAQ**, the **S&P 500**, and the top 50 U.S. companies, and I am now considering investing.

## Reflection 9: Real-World Relevance

This project closely **mirrored** the **challenges faced in real engineering projects**. We dealt with **incomplete** and **delayed data**, **sudden changes** in team structure, and **unexpected personal setbacks** such as health issues. These are the kinds of **unpredictable variables that engineers often face** in professional environments, **where deadlines remain fixed regardless of circumstances**.

An additional value was that our work was based on an actual LBP case from a real company. This transformed the project from a purely academic exercise into a real-world problem-solving experience. Every calculation, analysis, and recommendation had a practical context and potential impact.

## Reflection 10: Team Members

In this section I will evaluate each one of the team members I worked with.

- **Abdullah Al – Momany:** Not much to say, he was the only one in the first team who showed interest, took initiative, completed his work (even if its not correct). However, it was hard to get in touch with him in critical times.
- **Bahaa Al – Shorman:** In the first team, as most of us, Bahaa was affected by lack of excitement. It was easy to reach out to him, always completed his part (sometimes late).

**After the separation**, he changed his attitude 180 degrees. Worked many hours to get data that was **intentionally hidden**. He reached out to tax department to understand it. Showed extreme professionalism in the critical time.

- **Yousaf Riyad:** words cannot explain how much Yousef hurt the team, project and everyone worked with him. Starting with the meetings, we agreed on what each one should say, but Yousef took the initiative in the meeting and tried to explain it all alone, where he failed.

And yet, the worst part to come. He asked to take responsibility of Data Collection, refused to get Bahaa's help, wasted almost 10 days to remove client name, even if his part was just getting a proposal file, he refused to help in calculations and sent the so-called data late (personally I thought it was a joke when he sent a screenshot with 5 figures).

Additionally, when Bahaa took responsibility of Data Collection after the separation, he found an huge amount of data that we took. And another set of data, for a much bigger project than the one we got, but we could not change the project couple days before submission. All of that was offered to Yousef by Modern Co Supervisor. Which he refused to take. He confirmed that himself to Bahaa saying  
... 'مش فارقته معي العلامة'

**Ramez Al – Masadeh:** from my point of view, I do admit I did not show interest, ignored massages in work hours. However, when I was asked to do something, I do it, made sure it was right and always checked others work. Before the separation, I tried to provide ideas for the team, but I was ignored.